Frequently Asked Questions

BME554L (Fall 2026)

2026-08-22

Table of contents

MacOS Troubleshooting 1
Ejection Warnings & Serial Communication Blocks 1
Permission Denied when Upgrading `nrfutil` 1
Permission Issues when Flashing 2
Tab Autocompletion 2

MacOS Troubleshooting

Ejection Warnings & Serial Communication Blocks

The MacOS can try to mount your development kit as a storage device, and this can (a) interfere with flashing the device, (b) prevent you from seeing `VCOM` port output, and (c) annoyingly pop up a warning dialog window saying that your storage device was not unmounted properly. To avoid this, you can do the following: https://docs.zephyrproject.org/latest/develop/flash_debug/nordic_segger.html#disabling-the-mass-storage-device-functionality

Permission Denied when Upgrading `nrfutil`

When attempting to run `nrfutil self-upgrade` or other subsequent commands detailed for nrfutil, on macOS, if you encounter `permission denied`, navigate to the directory where you saved the nrfutil binary (via terminal) and run `chmod u+x nrfutil` to adjust its permissions. You can verify the effect of this by running `ls -l` before and after.

Permission Issues when Flashing

The nRF Command Line Tools are in the process of converting from using a legacy `nrfjprog` tool to `nrfutil`. Some of the latest versions of the command line tools on the MacOS have bugs that prevent you from running the legacy tools without root privileges. If you run into this issue, you can try **downgrading** your `nRF Command Line Tools` to an earlier version (specifically, `v10.24.0`).

Tab Autocompletion

If your Mac terminal doesn't have `tab` autocompletion enabled when typing out your long branch name you created among other git commands, follow the steps from this link.

This will only work in your Mac terminal. If you'd like to enable this in VS Code as well, open up your preferences with `Cmd + ,`, and then navigate through this:

- `User -> Extensions -> Git`.
- Scroll down to the setting labeled `Terminal Git Editor` and check this box.
- You will need to restart your existing terminal inside of VS Code if one is already open.